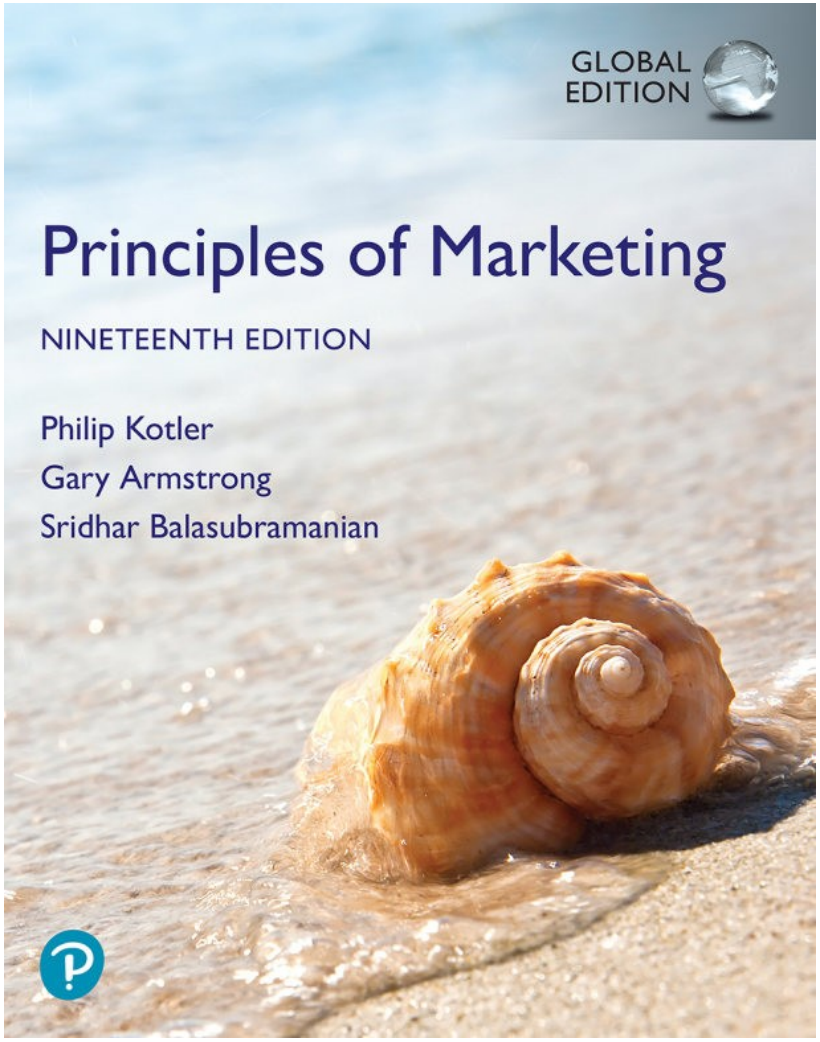
Principles of Marketing

Nineteenth Edition, Global Edition



Chapter 5

Consumer Markets and Buyer Behavior

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Learning Objectives

5.1 Define the consumer market and construct a simple model of consumer buyer behavior.

5.2 Explore the four major factors that influence consumer buyer behavior.

5.3 Understand the stages in the buyer decision process and the major types of buying decision behavior.

5.4 Describe the adoption and diffusion process for new products.

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Beyond Meat: Changing Consumer Attitudes and Behavior, One Burger at a Time

Changing ingrained consumer attitudes and behaviors can be difficult. But Beyond Meat is off to a good start with its plant-based meat products. The Beyond Burger “cooks like a beef patty. It sizzles, it oozes. And sizzle, we know, is what sells.”

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Learning Objective 1

Define the consumer market and construct a simple model of consumer buyer behavior.

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Consumer Markets and Buyer Behavior

Consumer buyer behavior is the buying behavior of final consumers—individuals and households that buy goods and services for personal consumption.

Consumer markets are made up of all the individuals and households that buy or acquire goods and services for personal consumption.

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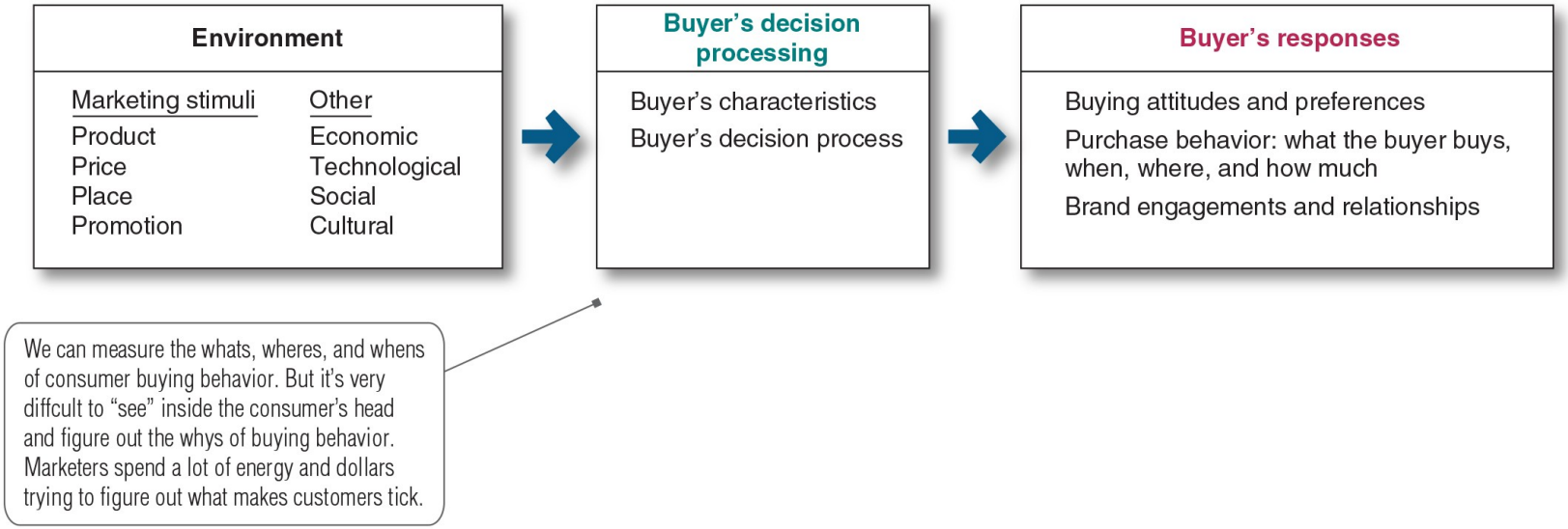
Model of Consumer Behavior

Figure 5.1 A Model of Buyer Behavior



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Learning Objective 2

Explore the four major factors that influence consumer buyer behavior.

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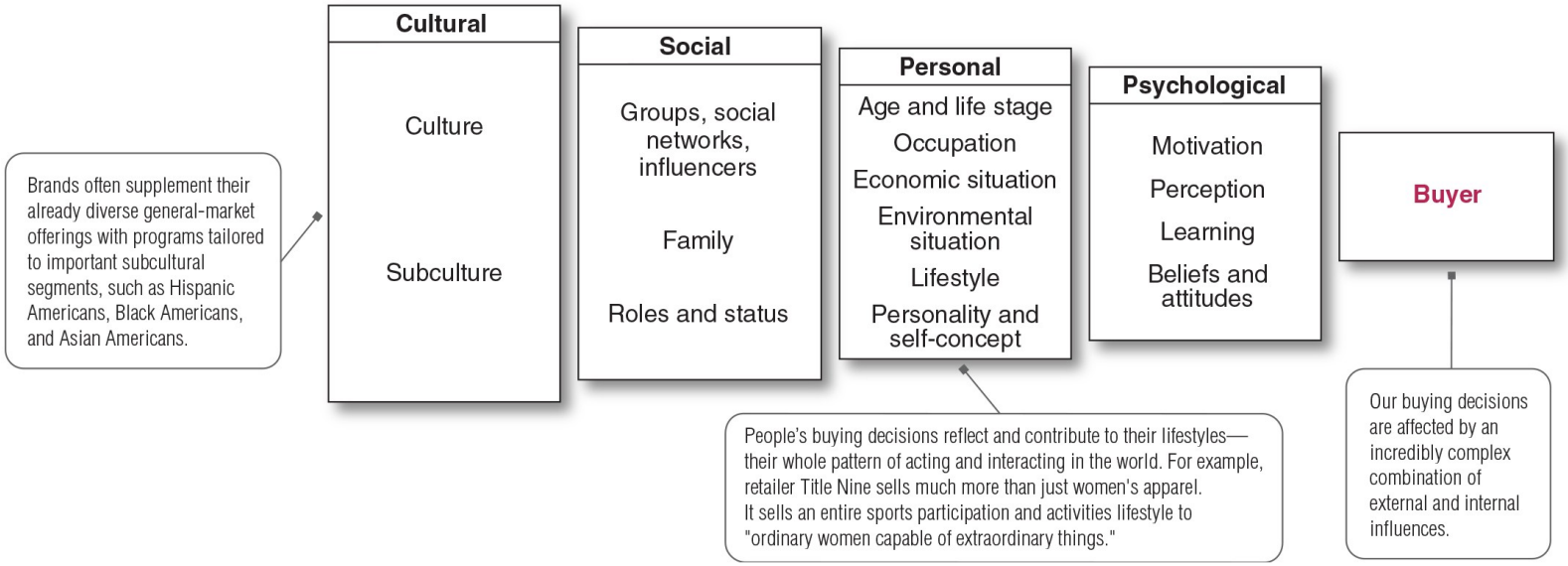
Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (1 of 16)

Figure 5.2 Factors Influencing Consumer Behavior



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Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (2 of 16)

Cultural Factors

Culture is the set of basic values, perceptions, wants, and behaviors learned by a member of society from family and other important institutions.

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Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (3 of 16)

Cultural Factors

Subcultures are groups of people within a culture with shared value systems based on common life experiences and situations.

Marketing to Hispanic American consumers: Select McDonald's restaurants in communities with deep Latin roots—here, Miami's iconic Little Havana neighborhood—launched *Ritmo y Color McDonald's* (Rhythm and Color McDonald's) experiences, transforming local restaurants into vibrant expressions of their Hispanic roots.

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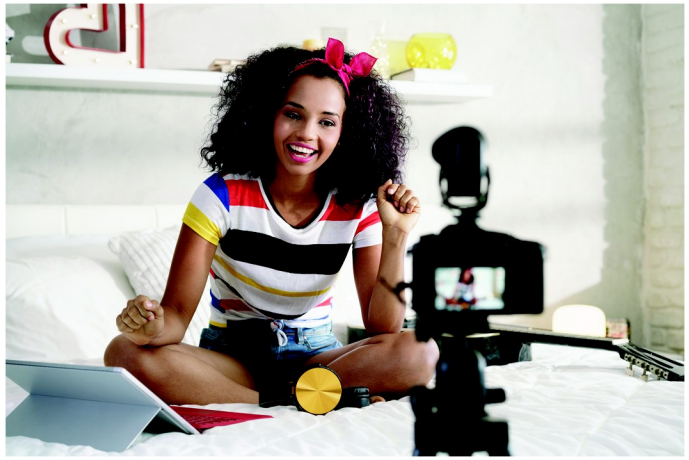
Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (4 of 16)

Cultural Factors

Real Marketing 5.1:Micro-Influencers: Sometimes Smaller Is Better

Instead of paying top dollar to a small group of mega-influencers, many brands now are partnering with a larger number of smaller micro-influencers to give a more authentic, focused, and affordable voice to their brand.



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Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (5 of 16)

Groups and Social Networks

- Reference groups
- Opinion leaders
- Word-of-mouth influence
- Influencer marketing
- Online social networks

Targeting Black American consumers: P&G's "My Black Is Beautiful" campaign aims to spark conversation by, for, and about black women to effect positive change. The campaign helps to build positive relationships between P&G brands and black consumers.

Tasia Wells/Stringer/Getty Images

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Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (6 of 16)

Social Factors

- **Family** is the most important consumer-buying organization in society.
- **Role and status** can be defined by a person's position in a group.

Embracing diversity, equity, and inclusiveness: Responding to renewed calls for racial equity, several companies have renamed, repositioned, and reimaged well-known but culturally insensitive brands. For example, Quaker rebranded its Aunt Jemima pancake mixes and syrups as Pearl Milling Company products, named after the small mill that first produced the pancake products.

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Discussion Question (1 of 2)

How do social factors influence a buyer's behavior?

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Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (7 of 16)

Personal Factors

Occupation affects the goods and services bought by consumers.

Age and Life Stage affect tastes in food, clothes, furniture, ad recreation.

Economic situations include trends in spending, personal income, savings, interest rates.

Appealing to occupation segments: Caterpillar makes rugged, durable phones for construction and other heavy industries.

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Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (8 of 16)

Personal Factors

Lifestyle is a person's pattern of living as expressed in his or her psychographics.

Personality refers to the unique psychological characteristics that distinguish a person or group.

Lifestyles: The Body Shop markets much more than just beauty products; its cosmetics seek to embody the ethical consumerism lifestyle.

uk retail Alan King/Alamy Stock Photo

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Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (9 of 16)

Brand personality: Ford's market-leading F-series pickup truck brand is positioned on toughness—Built Ford Tough—conveying quality, durability, and resilience.

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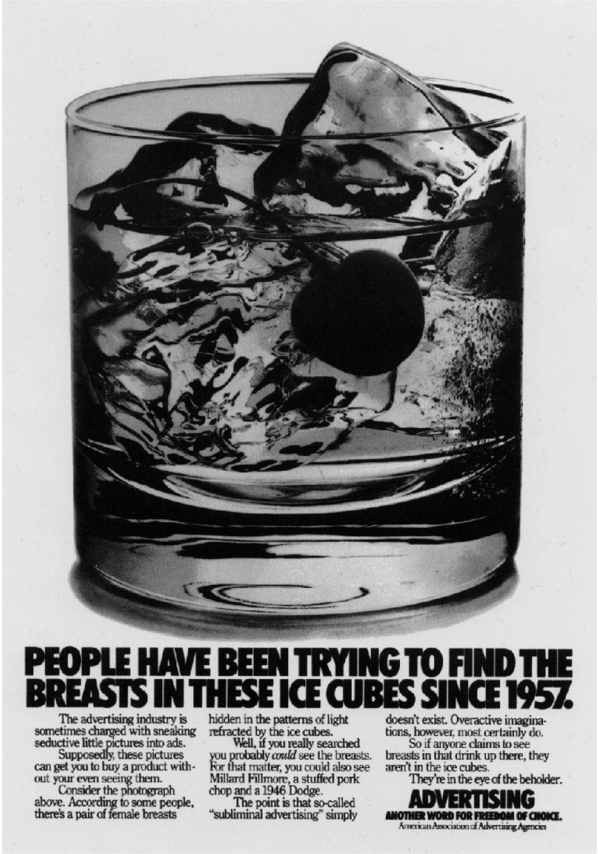
Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (10 of 16)

Psychological Factors

- Motivation
- Perception
- Learning
- Beliefs and attitudes

This classic ad from the American Association of Advertising Agencies pokes fun at subliminal advertising. “So-called ‘subliminal advertising’ simply doesn’t exist,” says the ad. “Overactive imaginations, however, most certainly do.”



American Association of Advertising Agencies

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Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (11 of 16)

Psychological Factors

A **motive** (or **drive**) is a need that is sufficiently pressing to direct the person to seek satisfaction of the need.

Motivation research refers to qualitative research designed to probe consumers' hidden, subconscious motivations.

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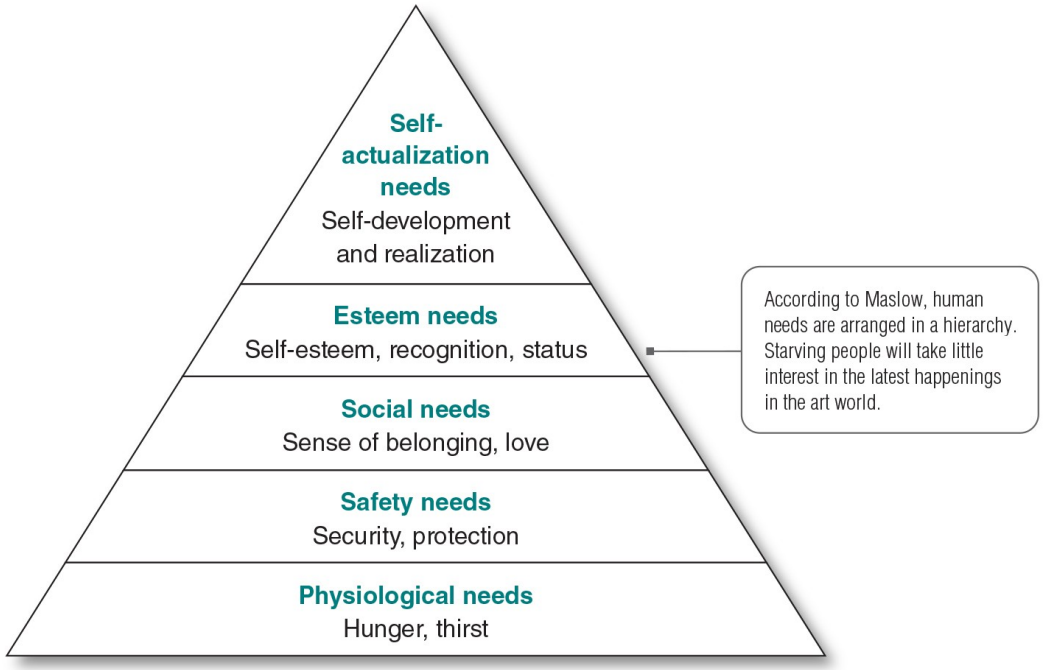
Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (12 of 16)

Figure 5.3 Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs



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Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (13 of 16)

Psychological Factors

Perception is the process by which people select, organize, and interpret information to form a meaningful picture of the world.

Perceptual Processes

- Selective attention
- Selective distortion
- Selective retention

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Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (14 of 16)

Psychological Factors

Selective attention is the tendency for people to screen out most of the information to which they are exposed.

Selective distortion is the tendency for people to interpret information in a way that will support what they already believe.

Selective retention is the tendency to remember good points made about a brand they favor and forget good points made about competing brands.

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Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (15 of 16)

Psychological Factors

Learning is the change in an individual's behavior arising from experience and occurs through the interplay of:

- Drives
- Stimuli
- Cues
- Responses
- Reinforcement

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Characteristics Affecting Consumer Behavior (16 of 16)

Psychological Factors

A **belief** is a descriptive thought that a person has about something based on:

- Knowledge
- Opinion
- Faith

An **attitude** describes a person's relatively consistent evaluations, feelings, and tendencies toward an object or idea.

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SPANX: Changing the Way Women Think about “Shapewear”

SPANX and founder Sara Blakely have fundamentally changed the way consumers think about clothing and their body shapes. It’s not “foundationwear” anymore. “Shapewear is the canvas and clothes are the art.”

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Learning Objective 3

Understand the stages in the buyer decision process and the major types of buying decision behavior.

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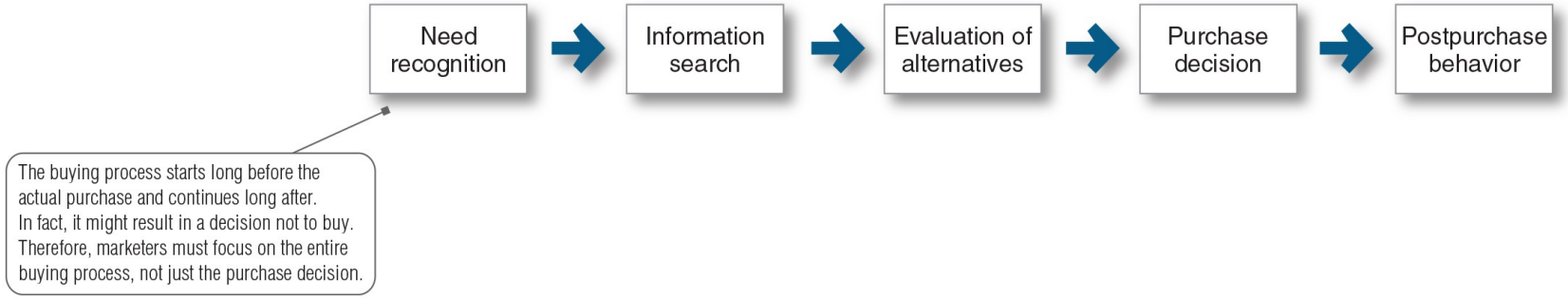
Figure 5.4

Buyer Decision Process



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Types of Buying Decision Behavior (1 of 2)

- Complex buying behavior
- Dissonance-reducing buying behavior
- Habitual buying behavior
- Variety-seeking buying behavior

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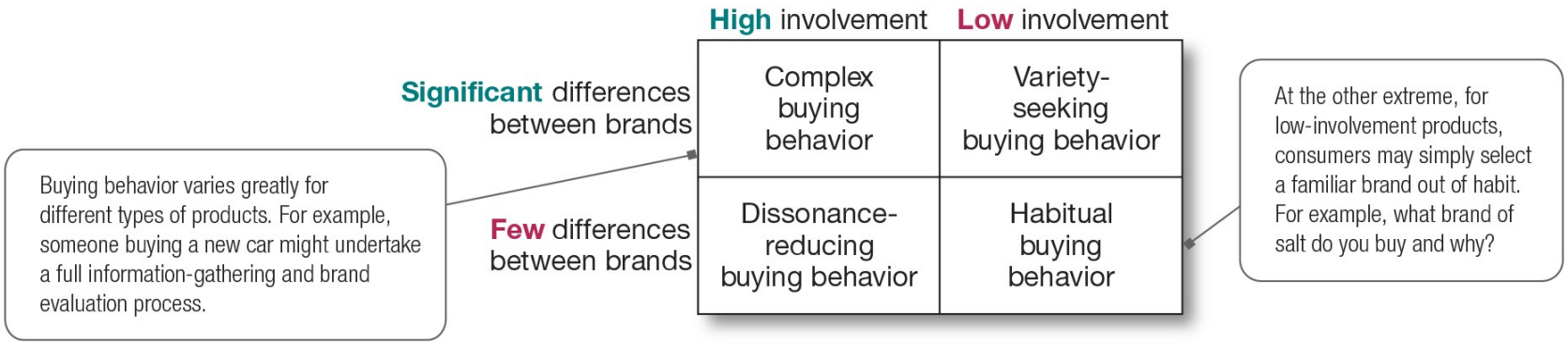
Types of Buying Decision Behavior (2 of 2)

Figure 5.5 Four Types of Buying Behavior



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The Buyer Decision Process (1 of 6)

Need Recognition

Need recognition is the first stage of the buyer decision process, in which the consumer recognizes a problem or need triggered by:

- Internal stimuli
- External stimuli

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The Buyer Decision Process (2 of 6)

Information Search

Information search is the stage of the buyer decision process in which the consumer is motivated to search for more information.

- **Sources of information:**
  - Personal sources
  - Commercial sources
  - Public sources
  - Experiential sources

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The Buyer Decision Process (3 of 6)

Evaluation of Alternatives

Alternative evaluation is the stage of the buyer decision process in which the consumer uses information to evaluate alternative brands in the choice set.

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The Buyer Decision Process (4 of 6)

Purchase Decision

Purchase decision is the buyer's decision about which brand to purchase.

The purchase **intention** may not be the purchase **decision** due to:

- Attitudes of others
- Unexpected situational factors

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The Buyer Decision Process (5 of 6)

Postpurchase Behavior

Postpurchase behavior is the stage of the buyer decision process in which consumers take further action after purchase, based on their satisfaction or dissatisfaction.

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The Buyer Decision Process (6 of 6)

Postpurchase Behavior

Cognitive dissonance is buyer discomfort caused by postpurchase conflict.

Postpurchase customer satisfaction: Postpurchase customer satisfaction is a key to building profitable customer relationships. Most marketers go beyond merely meeting the customer expectations—they aim to delight customers.

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The Customer Journey

Customer journey: the sum of the ongoing experiences consumers have with a brand that affect their buying behavior, engagement, and brand advocacy over time.

The customer journey: By understanding the customer journey, marketers can work to create brand experiences that will result in positive purchase behavior, engagement, and brand advocacy over time.

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Discussion Question (2 of 2)

Why must marketers understand the customer journey?

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Learning Objective 4

Describe the adoption and diffusion process for new products.

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The Buyer Decision Process for New Products (1 of 3)

The **adoption process** is the mental process an individual goes through from first learning about an innovation to final regular use.

- Stages in the adoption process include:
  - Awareness
  - Interest
  - Evaluation
  - Trial
  - Adoption

L'Oréal has invested deeply in technologies that make a customer's journey as full and fulfilling as possible. The ongoing aim is "to provide services to our consumers to help them discover, try, buy, and experience our brands."

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The Buyer Decision Process for New Products (2 of 3)

Individual Differences in Innovativeness

- Innovators
- Early Adopters
- Early Mainstream
- Late Mainstream
- Lagging Adopters

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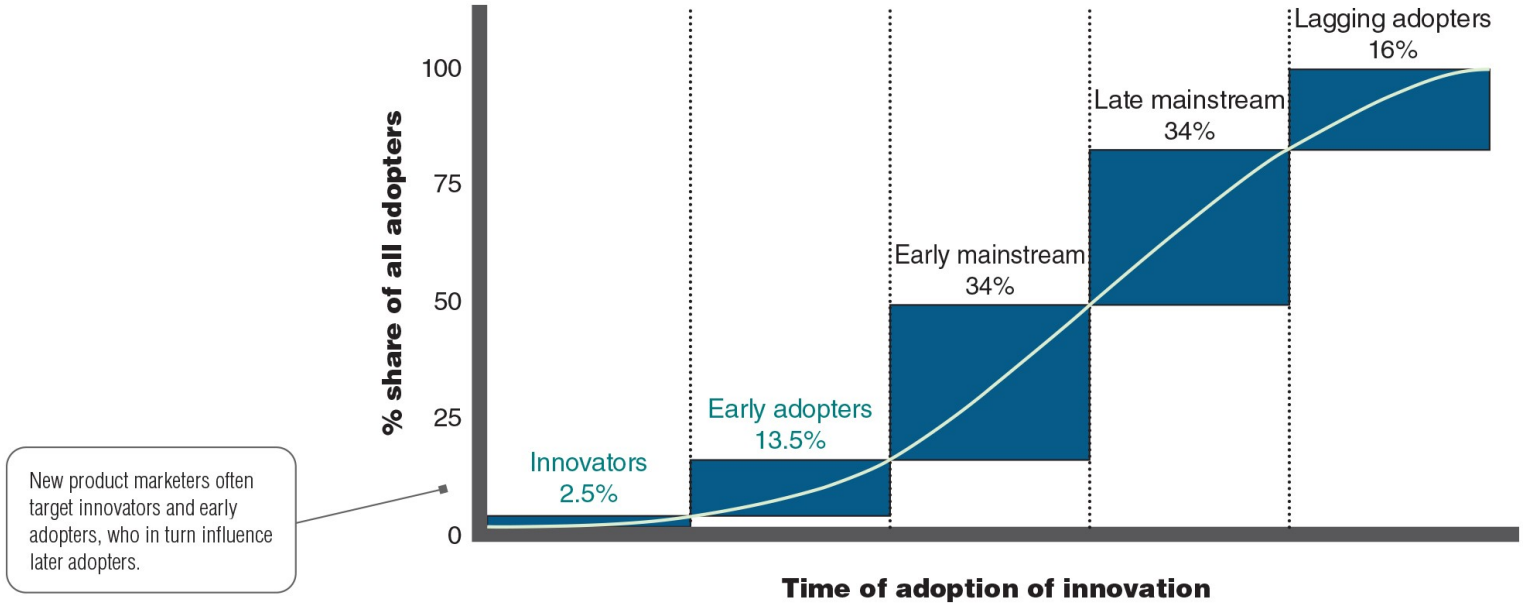
The Buyer Decision Process for New Products (3 of 3)

Figure 5.6 Adopter Categories Based on Relative Time of Adoption of Innovations



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Analyzing and Using Marketing Information

Influence of Product Characteristics on Rate of Adoption

- Relative advantage
- Compatibility
- Complexity
- Trialability
- Observability

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